

# ENRIQUE PABON RAMIREZ

**Industrial Engineer & MBA | Director of Agroindustrial Development | Artificial Intelligence (AI) expert**

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE / SUMMARY

Bilingual Industrial Engineer with an MBA and 15+ years of experience leading transformation in highly regulated and operationally complex sectors, including agroindustry, pharmaceutical cannabis, glass manufacturing, and automotive. I design and deliver AI and data-enabled solutions, from scoping to implementation and scale, across end-to-end supply chains, operations, and commercial functions. Recent work focuses on AI-powered process optimization, computer vision, conversational agents, and no-code automation integrated with ERP and BI environments. I build AI literacy and adoption among non-technical stakeholders, ensuring responsible and ethical AI aligned with governance, transparency, and data privacy principles. Motivated to apply AI for resilient food systems, inclusive value chains, and improved livelihoods in mission-driven, global organizations.

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## CORE SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

- AI & Data: AI/ML concepts; LLMs and generative AI; prompt design; agentic AI concepts; computer vision for quality control; data analytics and performance monitoring
  - Responsible AI: ethical AI governance awareness; risk, bias, and transparency considerations; data privacy awareness in regulated environments
  - Solution Design & Delivery: AI solution scoping; requirements gathering; prototyping and piloting; integration with ERP and BI; change management
  - Platforms & Tools: experience with cloud-based data/analytics environments; SAP and Netsuite ERP; BI dashboards and analytics UIs; Notion, ClickUp; basic Kinaxis for SAP
  - Automation & Agents: no-code automation (n8n); orchestration of multi-system workflows; AI-powered WhatsApp and conversational agents
  - Business & Operations: S&OP; end-to-end supply chain and logistics; demand planning; financial and operational planning; cost optimization
  - Stakeholders & Partnerships: multi-stakeholder project management; work with farmers and agricultural partners, plant operators, commercial and finance teams, and leadership
  - Capacity Strengthening & Learning: design and delivery of webinars and training; internal AI champion; facilitation for non-technical users; building informal communities of practice around AI and data
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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Director of Agroindustrial Development

*Oleoflores – Barranquilla, Colombia* | Jul 2024 – Present

Leading end-to-end planning and AI-enabled optimization for palm fruit supply to four extraction plants and crude palm oil flows to the refinery, working closely with farmers, field teams, and corporate leadership.

- Lead the design and implementation of a Smart-flow AI solution for palm oil extraction plants, automating end-to-end process flows, improving operational control and visibility, and integrating with SAP/ERP to support real-time decision making (add % efficiency or time saved if available).
- Coordinate the development of computer vision models for fruit quality classification and detection of under-processed bunches, strengthening quality control, reducing waste, and lowering operational risk (add % reduction in waste or rework if available).
- Implement no-code automations using n8n, orchestrating workflows between internal systems, external data sources, and communication channels to reduce manual work and improve data consistency (add FTE hours saved or % reduction in manual tasks if available).
- Act as an external webinar speaker on AI in business, having delivered more than five webinars for companies in Mexico, translating complex AI concepts into accessible, actionable guidance for non-technical corporate audiences.

- Lead the rollout of AI-powered WhatsApp advisory agents to support associated farmers and agricultural partners with timely information on deliveries, quality standards, and agronomic guidance, improving service quality and engagement.
- Design and govern interactive BI dashboards and analytics interfaces with integrated AI analysis to track supply, plant performance, and commercial indicators, enabling data-informed decisions by senior leadership and field managers.
- Establish S&OP cycles that link demand, capacity, and seasonal variability, aligning pricing, contracts, and sourcing strategies with supply risks and market dynamics.
- Promote AI and data literacy across operations, logistics, purchasing, and finance by running practical sessions, sharing guidelines on responsible AI use, and fostering a culture of experimentation and continuous improvement.

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### **Business Development Manager**

*Medcann Pharma – Bogotá, Colombia | May 2023 – Jun 2025*

Led commercial strategy and expansion of medicinal cannabis business lines in global markets, connecting regulated production with international clients and partners.

- Designed and executed business strategies for medicinal cannabis products across multiple markets, aligning commercial plans with regulatory, quality, and supply constraints.
- Led monthly data-driven performance reviews with dashboards tracking sales, pipeline, and market evolution, enabling earlier identification of high-potential markets and clients.
- Coordinated multi-stakeholder projects with operations, quality, finance, and legal to ensure compliant and timely delivery of client contracts and new product launches.
- Achieved the company's first successful export of micropropagated material from Colombia to Spain, demonstrating reliability of the supply chain under strict regulatory and quality standards.
- Expanded the client portfolio by 300% in the first year through structured outreach, relationship-building, and tailored service offerings.
- Implemented a CRM system to standardize client relationship management, improving visibility on opportunities and operational efficiency (add metrics on response time or conversion rate if available).
- Developed a B2B consulting line, leveraging company expertise to support partners and clients in building compliant, sustainable cannabis operations.

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### **General Manager – Colombia**

*YVY Life Sciences – Bogotá, Colombia | Feb 2022 – May 2023*

Accountable for financial and operational planning, production, and team leadership in Colombia within a regional medicinal cannabis company.

- Structured the operational and financial plan for the Colombian business, integrating production, commercial, and investment roadmaps and linking them to regulatory milestones.
- Designed the country business strategy and led negotiations for a joint venture agreement with a key local partner, expanding the company's footprint and access to local networks.
- Managed a multidisciplinary team using PMO methods, ensuring on-time delivery of projects and alignment with corporate strategy and compliance requirements.
- Launched new business lines and expanded the client base, supporting the development of high-value agricultural production under strict quality and traceability standards.
- Led cost optimization initiatives that reduced operating costs while maintaining quality and regulatory compliance (add % cost reduction if available).
- Contributed to international market expansion and certification processes, strengthening the company's position in regulated global value chains.

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### **Operations Manager**

*YVY Life Sciences – Montevideo, Uruguay | Nov 2020 – Feb 2022*

Managed and optimized the end-to-end supply chain and operations for medicinal cannabis production, supporting sustainable growth and export readiness.

- Re-designed the operating model to improve productivity and resource utilization across cultivation, processing, and logistics.
- Developed the 2021–2022 business plan, formalizing processes and policies for medium- and long-term growth in a highly regulated environment.
- Led a team of three, fostering a collaborative, high-performance culture with clear performance indicators and continuous feedback.
- Achieved production of over 3 tons of high-CBD flower and 300 kg of high-THC flower in 2022, surpassing production targets while maintaining quality.
- Directed a US\$500,000 capacity expansion project, coordinating engineering, finance, and operations to increase output and market readiness.
- Opened the Swiss market with first successful exports of high-CBD flower, positioning the company as an international player in the sector.

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### **Supply Chain Director**

*Avicanna Inc. – Santa Marta, Colombia | Jan 2018 – Nov 2020*

Built and led the supply chain function (purchasing, logistics, demand planning, and foreign trade) for a fast-growing medicinal cannabis company.

- Structured purchasing, logistics, demand planning, and international trade processes from the ground up, enabling scalable and compliant operations.
- Led a team of 10 professionals, establishing standard operating procedures, KPIs, and internal controls suitable for a regulated pharma-like environment.
- Managed more than US\$15M in CAPEX and OPEX purchases in 2019, negotiating with a portfolio of 50+ suppliers and aligning contracts with corporate strategy and quality requirements.
- Led the launch of the Pura Earth cosmetics brand, securing distribution agreements in Colombia and Ecuador and coordinating supply, regulatory, and marketing stakeholders.
- Directed the first export of cannabis seeds from Colombia to the United States (US\$450,000), positioning the company as an industry leader and opening new revenue streams.
- Worked closely with agricultural producers and partners to ensure consistent quality, traceability, and compliance across the value chain.

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### **Financial Controller – Plant**

*Owens-Illinois (O-I) – Bogotá, Colombia | Jun 2015 – Oct 2017*

- Led financial management for the Bogotá glass manufacturing plant, aligning budgets, forecasts, and capital projects with corporate targets.
- Served as company negotiator for the 2017 collective bargaining agreement, achieving an outcome aligned with company projections and legal timelines.
- Contributed to a 20% reduction in cost per ton produced (2016–YTD 2017) through productivity improvements, operating cost reductions, and adoption of “Total System Cost” methodology.
- Supported execution of ~US\$20M capital investment (furnace rebuild, forming machines, quality inspection equipment), ensuring financial control and on-time delivery.
- Coordinated the 2016 fixed asset inventory for the plant and mentored team members, supporting internal promotions.

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### **Project Manager – Manufacturing**

*General Motors – Bogotá, Colombia | Jun 2011 – Apr 2014*

- Planned, coordinated, and controlled major manufacturing projects (Stamping, Hemming, Body Shop Sail) with budgets of approximately US\$30M, US\$5M, and US\$8M respectively.
- Led cross-functional, interdisciplinary teams to deliver projects on time and within budget, improving productivity, quality, and safety conditions on the shop floor.

- Applied best practices and lessons learned to reduce operational risks and enhance process reliability in a large-scale, global automotive environment.

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## SELECTED AI & DATA PROJECTS

Visite Website: [www.enriquepabon.com](http://www.enriquepabon.com)

- **Smart-flow AI for Palm Oil Extraction Plants – Oleoflores**

Designed and led an AI-driven smart-flow system to orchestrate process steps across multiple extraction plants, integrate with SAP, and provide real-time visibility on throughput, bottlenecks, and quality. Resulted in higher plant utilization, improved planning accuracy, and faster response to operational issues (add quantified impacts if available).

- **Computer Vision for Fruit Quality & Process Control – Oleoflores**

Spearheaded development of computer vision models to classify palm fruit quality and detect under-processed bunches, feeding data into quality dashboards and operational alerts. Strengthened quality assurance, reduced waste and reprocessing, and supported more sustainable use of raw materials.

- **AI-Powered WhatsApp Advisory Agents for Farmers – Oleoflores**

Co-designed and deployed conversational agents on WhatsApp to provide farmers and agricultural partners with guidance on deliveries, quality requirements, and basic agronomic recommendations. Improved responsiveness, transparency, and trust with rural stakeholders while reducing dependence on manual call-center interactions.

- **No-Code Automation with n8n for Operational Workflows – Oleoflores**

Implemented automated workflows connecting ERP data, logistics systems, messaging channels, and reporting tools using n8n. Reduced repetitive manual tasks, improved data quality, and accelerated information flow between field operations and central teams.

- **AI-Augmented BI Dashboards for Leadership Decision-Making – Oleoflores and Previous Roles**

Built interactive BI dashboards and analytics interfaces that combine structured metrics with AI-generated insights and narratives, helping senior leaders and operational managers monitor performance, identify anomalies, and prioritize actions across supply chain and commercial functions.

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## EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

### Master in Business Administration (MBA)

EAE Business School – Madrid, Spain | 2015

### BSc in Industrial Engineering

Universidad de los Andes – Bogotá, Colombia | 2010

### Languages

- Spanish – Native
- English – Professional working proficiency (C1)
- Portuguese – Basic conversational level